BERNSTEIN
SOCIETE GENERALE GROUP

Global Aerospace & Defense

Space Exploration Technologies Corporation

Rating

Outperform

Price Target

SPCX 248.00 USD



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SpaceX: Elon forecasts next Starship launch timing and goals - Targeting the catch of both stages

Over the weekend, in an interview, Elon Musk described his expectations for upcoming Starship launches.

Launch 15 is now expected to occur in the next four to six weeks. The goal in that launch will be to catch both the Super Heavy booster and the Starship second stage with the chopsticks at Starbase. This timing of early to mid-November is later than we expected the launch to happen. But, if the goal of catching both stages can be achieved on that launch, this would be more significant.

Elon said that he gives them a 50-60% chance of success for catching both stages on this launch. SpaceX has a history of setting aggressive goals, which are not always achieved on time. But, we see this as encouraging that the company believes it could do both catches on the next launch.

He also said that the following launch, Launch 16, could be done reusing both of these stages. We assume this is an indication of SpaceX confidence in the heat shield performance in the last launch, Launch 14.

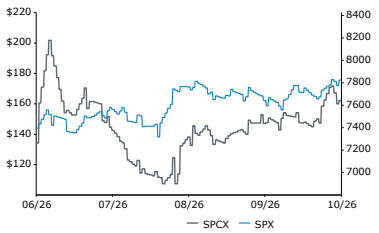
Rapid reuse will be the key to achieving the company's objectives with respect to orbital data centers, which is the most important element in our valuation. There is still a long way to go before rapid reuse is in place. But, if it can be demonstrated on launch's 15 and 16, that will be a big step forward. For background also see, "*SpaceX, Howmet: Two ways to kill data centers on earth? Our Bernstein Data Center Day presentation*".

Close Date	9 Oct 2026
SPCX Close Price (USD)	162.57
Price Target (USD)	248.00
Upside/(Downside)	53%
52-Week Range	225.64/104.83
SPX	7,811.54
FYE	Dec
Div Yield	NA
Market Cap (USD) (B)	2,206.53
EV (USD) (B)	2,145.89

Performance	YTD	1M	6M	12M
Absolute (%)	NA	10.2	NA	NA
SPX (%)	14.1	2.3	14.5	16.0
Relative (%)	NA	7.9	NA	NA

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

Price Performance, 1YR



Adjusted EPS	F25A	F26E	F27E
SPCX (USD)	--	(0.19)	1.37

Financials	F25A	F26E	F27E	CAGR
Revenues (M)	18,674	46,665	152,220	--
Adjusted EBITDA	6,584.0	21,360.0	87,689.0	--

Valuation Metrics	F25A	F26E	F27E
Adjusted P/E (x)		(855.6)	118.9
EV/Adj EBITDA (x)	325.9	100.5	24.5

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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INVESTMENT IMPLICATIONS

We rate SpaceX Outperform, Target $248.

BERNSTEIN TICKER TABLE

			9 Oct 2026		TTM	Adjusted EPS				Adjusted P/E (x)	
			Closing	Price	Rel.						
Ticker	Rating	Cur	Price	Target	Perf.	Cur	2025A	2026E	2027E	2025A	2026E	2027E
SPCX (SpaceX)	O	USD	162.57	248.00	NA	USD		(0.19)	1.37		(855.6)	118.9
SPX			7,811.54									

O - Outperform, M - Market-Perform, U - Underperform, NR - Not Rated, CS - Coverage Suspended

Source: Bloomberg, Bernstein estimates and analysis.

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VALUATION METHODOLOGY

Space Exploration Technologies Corporation

We base our valuation approach on 12-month forward EV/EBITDA applied to 2031 EBITDA. We believe it is necessary to use a long-term period (i.e., 2031) because the cornerstone of the value is in the orbital data centers. Applying a multiple to, say, 2028 EBITDA would not capture any of that business - i.e., it would simply be space launch, terrestrial compute and near-term Starlink. We use a sum of the parts methodology to give an EV/EBITDA valuation in 2030 (based on 2031 values). We then discount that valuation backward for each segment to mid-2027 in order to reach a one year target price of $248.

RISKS

Space Exploration Technologies Corporation

Downside Risks to our Outperform rating and $248 price target include the ability to dramatically growth Starship launch capacity over time, which depends on full reusability. SpaceX must be able to operationalize its orbital data centers to deliver on the valuation. Semiconductor availability could also be a constraint, as could other potential supply chain issues. There are also risks associated with potential launch incidents or regulatory restrictions. Should compute demand be more limited than most expectations, that would form another risk.

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Bernstein brand stock ratings are based on a 12-month time horizon.

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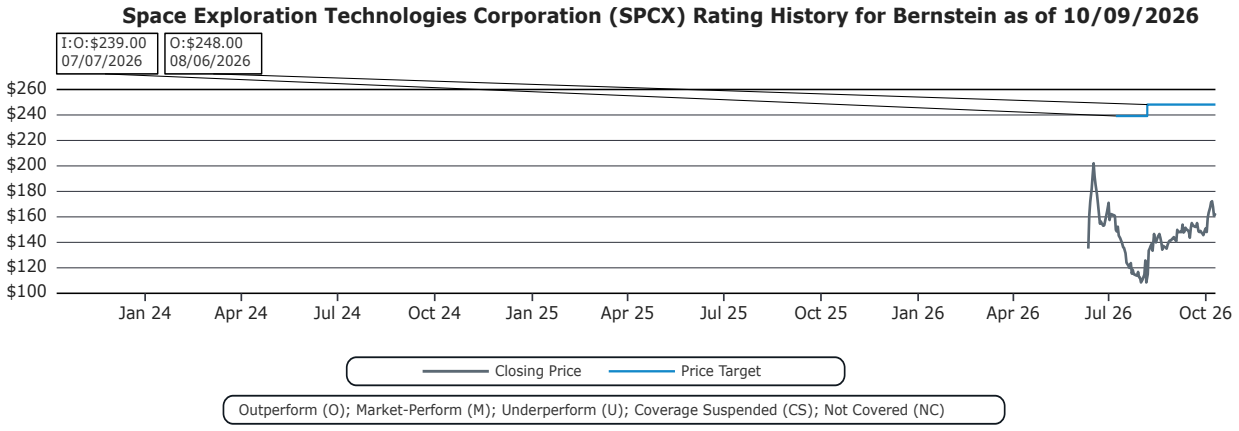
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Outperform	BUY	52.3%	14.2%
Market-Perform (Bernstein Brand) Neutral (Autonomous Brand)	HOLD	35.6%	16.1%
Underperform	SELL	12.1%	13.6%

* These figures represent the percentage of companies within each equity rating category for which affiliates of Bernstein have provided investment banking services within the previous 12 months.
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